



THE SLAV REMAKE OF QUAKE

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If you've been following the past couple of Indie Spotlights then you know that we've got an eye for shooters that go out of their way to bring the old classic FPS experience back.

HROT is a retro FPS set in 1986, Czechoslovakia. Once you take a look at the screenshots on its Steam page, you'll be inclined to believe that the game was made in the same year it is set in. But no, it was released in January 2021 and has been gaining "Overwhelmingly Positive" reviews ever since.

Gameplay

Gameplay wise, HROT really does pick up a couple of elements from Quake. Hence, why we've called it the "Slav remake of Quake" in the leader. During our time with the game, we found HROT to be more similar to Quake than any other old FPS game we could find. Before pointing out the similarities, let us first get to know the game better.

You start out inside a room with nothing but a pistol. Now usually in such games, the first level is the "tutorial", but HROT takes a different approach by throwing you into the chaos and expecting you to learn along the way. There's no tutorial, but since the mechanics are really simple, the user takes almost no time to adapt to it. You

got WASD to move, E to use, Space to jump, M1 to fire, M2 to throw a grenade and F to use the flashlight.

Graphics

This is where the game excels. The graphics. What makes this game special is that this game was not built with the help of any modern game engine like Unity or Unreal Engine 5. Instead, according to the Steam listing of this game, the



game engine used here is "A custom engine written in Pascal imitating 1990s software-style rendering with unfiltered textures and polygon jitter." Now that's what we call dedication. This absolute madlad wrote a whole game engine, that too in Pascal of all the languages just to imitate the "old-style rendering" that games of the time had.

The whole game has an eerie brown filter all over it. Almost everything is just another shade of brown in the game and honestly, that gives us the creeps. The character models are pixelated and low resolution.



The gun models are the only models in the game which have just a hint of smooth edges.

Graphics wise, if there is one thing that this game has nailed, it is the environment and the buildings. The sky is overcast with clouds and tall buildings litter the landscape, with various artefacts around them. According to the Steam listing, the developer has tried to make these buildings and artefacts as close to real life as possible. Every level has its own set of weird artefacts. From a rotating gorilla with "swan-poles" to an abandoned children's playground in the middle of the level, there has been a lot of attention to detail and we appreciate that.

Similarities With Quake

From the moment we laid our eyes upon this game, we knew something looked familiar. Slowly, as we started playing through the game, we realised that HROT has a lot of similarities with Quake. We are nei-